Malfeasance

by James Canon



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Author's note: The 3 fairies may be combined into two or one fairy, depending on the performer's preference.

MALEFICENT. (*rehearsing*) Listen up! No, too informal… You fools! Listen to me while I curse your baby… No, too rhyme-y… Hey, listen to this!... Too cheerful.

DIAVAL. (*as a crow*) Caw! Caw!

MALEFICENT. Oh, thank evilness! Diaval… Into a man. (*casts a spell and turns crow into a man*)

DIAVAL. Ugh, my lady. I know you *can* transform me into anything—a dog, a dragon…there was that awkward toothbrush incident—but I am a crow and I wish you would just let me be.

MALEFICENT. Oh, stop whining and help me.

DIAVAL. Working on the curse for the princess' party.

MALEFICENT. Yes. What to do? What to do? I could steal her voice, give her boils, ruin her finances, give her "front butt"…

DIAVAL. Well…sounds like you've got a lot of ideas. Why don't you just, you know, give from the heart? Just go with the evil flow.

MALEFICENT. Hmmm…very good. (*spell*) Into a writing desk.

DIAVAL. What? No! I— (*changes*)

MALEFICENT. Hahahaha. I know why a raven is like a writing desk.

DIAVAL. (*as a desk*) I'm a crow!

TRANSITION

FAIRY 1. Happy birthday Princess!

FAIRY 2. Happy birthday to the princess!

FAIRY 1. Happy birthday to…who?

KING. Happy birthday to my daughter! My people, I have been a great king for you.

PEASANT. Actually, sir—

KING. Death! But seriously, you're lucky to have me. Now then, who brought presents for my daughter?

OLD MAN. I have brought her a frock made of gold… It's heavy.

CHILD. I'll play my drums for her ba rump ba bum bum.

KING. Yes, yes, all very good… What? What's going on? Who brought all this thunder and smoke?

MALEFICENT. Now listen well, ye foolish fooly fools!

DIAVAL. Overdid it.

MALEFICENT. Dang it. Nevertheless! I am Maleficent, and I am here to curse your beloved princess. She will have beauty and she will have riches…

KING. This sounds like one heck of a curse.

MALEFICENT. BUT!

KING. Spoke too soon.

MALEFICENT. On the eve of her eighteenth birthday she will…prick her finger on a spinning wheel!

KING. No! Wait, what?

MALEFICENT. Yes, it will sting worse than a papercut. It will itch more than a bug bite. It will bleed *slightly* less than an actual cut.

DIAVAL. …and then?

MALEFICENT. And then? Oh, and then…she will fall asleep… Forever!

KING. No! That's a long time!

MALEFICENT. And nothing can save her except for true love's kiss, because that's not real! Muahahaha-boohoohoo! (*laughter turns into tears*)

DIAVAL. Maleficent?

MALEFICENT. Oh, sorry. Too real. Now then, I have spoken and so it shall be!

KING. Death! Seize her and give her death!

DIAVAL. Time to go.

MALEFICENT. Yes. Ok, Diaval, into a getaway! (*He transforms and she buzzes away.*)

KING. Dang it! Fairies! Surely you can do something!

FAIRY 1. We can take her to the forest. Raise her far away from all spinning wheels.

FAIRY 2. We'll return her on the day after her eighteenth birthday. Then she will have defied the curse, and she'll be safe.

FAIRY 3. And we'll be old!

FAIRY 1. She will not know of the curse or her true identity. We'll tell her on her eighteenth birthday.

KING. That'll be one big birthday surprise. All right, that's the plan. In the meantime, we shall hunt Malefaction.

FAIRY 1. Maleficent.

KING. Malignancy?

FAIRY 2. Maleficent.

KING. Malnutrition?

FAIRY 1. Close enough.

TRANSITION

DIAVAL. (*as a crow*) Caw! Caw!

MALEFICENT. (*spell*) Into a narrator!

DIAVAL. (*transforms to a narrator*) And so seventeen years passed with the King hunting Maleficent and the princess blossoming under the watchful eyes of the fairies. However, the princess and Maleficent's path were soon to cross again, on the eve of Aurora's eighteenth birthday…

AURORA. (*singing*) LA LA LA LA-A-A-A-A!

MALEFICENT. Ahh! What is that awful joyous noise? It offends my ears. It scorches my soul. It chafes my unmentionables!

AURORA. Oh, hello! I was just singing to the trees and rocks.

MALEFICENT. You were…what?

AURORA. You see: the trees and the rocks are my only friends. I had a squirrel friend once, but well, he was nuts.

MALEFICENT. Who and what are you?

AURORA. My name is Princess Aurora. It's a strange name for a peasant girl being raised by three winged aunts in the dead of the forest, but there you have it.

MALEFICENT. Princess (*hisses…then tries to cover it up with a cough*) how lovely to meet you.

AURORA. And you as well! What an incredible day I've had: meeting two new friends.

MALEFICENT. Two? Who was the other?

AURORA. A prince!

MALEFICENT. A prince? This cannot be. (*casts a spell at AURORA*) Go…unconscious.

AURORA. Why that's a silly thing to—(*unconscious*)

MALEFICENT. Diaval?!

DIAVAL. Maleficent was furious, for she knew that princes had a nasty habit of breaking curses and—

MALEFICENT. What are you doing?

DIAVAL. She had forgotten that she had turned the handsome little crow into a narrator.

MALEFICENT. Stop it.

DIAVAL. But he was unable.

MALEFICENT. I said stop it!

DIAVAL. And still, he was unable.

MALEFICENT. Ugh! Into a chair.

DIAVAL. Oh no, he thought— (*into a chair*)

MALEFICENT. (*sits down*) What am I going to do? If she meets that no good prince, all my plans are ruined. Why do these things always happen to me!?

AURORA. (*wakes*) Oh dear, why are you crying?

MALEFICENT. Oh great, now you're awake. Ugh, my magic never goes right.

AURORA. Did you say magic?

MALEFICENT. Yes, I said magic. What, have you gone deaf and dumb? Have you gone and hit your head on one of your little rock friends?

AURORA. Why then you must be my fairy godmother!

MALEFICENT. (*mimics*) Well then you must be my fairy god—what?

AURORA. It's true. Finally, a fairy godmother of my very own. I knew someday I'd meet you and you could guide me to true happiness.

MALEFICENT. True happiness?

AURORA. Yes. Like which dresses to where and what apples are poisoned and who my true love is. Oh you will help me, won't you?

MALEFICENT. (*to herself*) Fairy Godmother? I can work with that. (*to AURORA*) Ah, yes my dear. That's exactly what I am. But I'm your secret Fairy Godmother. My magic only works as long as you keep me an absolute secret.

AURORA. Don't worry, I won't tell the rocks or the trees.

MALEFICENT. Now then, I have a gift for you. (*conjures*) It's a spinning wheel… Mu ah ah ah ah!

AURORA. What's so funny?

MALEFICENT. What? Nothing. No, I was just thinking of this one time I conned an idiot into certain death. Come now, come now. You trust your dear sweet wonderful Fairy Godmother, don't you?

AURORA. Well, the spinning wheel is lovely. How does it work?

MALEFICENT. Simple, you hold out your hand.

AURORA. Alright.

MALEFICENT. That's it. Perfect. Right there. (*stabs her*) Ha!

AURORA. Oh dear.

MALEFICENT. Victory! And once we dispatch her true love, little sleeping beauty here will never awaken! Come, Diaval, we've got a prince to find.

TRANSITION

FAIRY 1. Aurora!?

FAIRY 2. Aurora?

FAIRY 3. Borealis!

FAIRY 1. Where on earth could she be? (*trips over her*) OOF!

FAIRY 3. Hey, someone left their princess just laying around.

FAIRY 1. Oh, no! It's Aurora. She's pricked her finger, and now she's asleep.

FAIRY 2. Now she'll sleep forever.

FAIRY 2. What about true love?

FAIRY 3. I love that show. Vampire Bill is my favorite.

FAIRY 1. You're an idiot. We must go and fetch the king!

FAIRY 2. What about her?

FAIRY 3. She's not going anywhere.

TRANSITION

PRINCE. Princess Aurora? Princess Aurora?

MALEFICENT. Looking for someone?

PRINCE. No. I just go around singing her name. Who are you?

MALEFICENT. I'm her fairy godmother. Mal-er-uh, Magnificent

PRINCE. Really? Well, it's nice to meet you Malera Magnificent. My name is Prince Phillip.

MALEFICENT. Isn't it pronounced "Phillip?"

PRINCE. No, it's more phonetic. Phillip. Yes, I was just on my way to the castle where I am to wed the daughter of the king. But then, oh, I met a beautiful country girl named Princess Aurora. And now my heart is split in two between the duty to marry the king's daughter and desire to marry Princess.

MALEFICENT. …you do know what the word Princess means, don't you?

PRINCE. Why yes, of course…oh! Oh! Oh! She's a princess! I can marry her!

MALEFICENT. Ha! Not so fast ye foolish fool hearted fool. For you have been fooled by my foolproof plan!

DIAVAL. Overdid it.

MALEFICENT. Dang it!

PRINCE. Wait…so you're not Princess Aurora's fairy godmother?

MALEFICENT. No, I am…

KING. Malemuit!

MALEFICENT. No, it's…

KING. Mellifluence!

MALEFICENT. MALEFICENT. Mal-ef-i-cent. You've had 18 years to practice. How hard is it really?

PRINCE. Fear not, my king. For I will dispense with this fiendish friendly fiend. I will *fiend* it within myself to Fien-nish this.

KING. Overdid it.

PRINCE. Dang it.

MALEFICENT. Bring it on, lover boy.

PRINCE. Oh, crap.

KING. Great. While you were having a soliloquy she turned into a dragon!

MALEFICENT. I don't mean to be a drag, but drag–gone it feels good to let loose my fiery side. Hahahahaha…cough cough…heart burn.

PRINCE. This one's for Princess Aurora! Ha! (*sword gets batted away*)

MALEFICENT. Nothing can stop me! (*gets hit*) I am… (*gets hit again*) What the devil?

PRINCE. Fly Princess Aurora's friends! Avenge her! (*throws a rock*)

MALEFICENT. You've got to be kidding me. Ow. Ow, stop that!

PRINCE. And you, too, trees! (*uses a tree as a weapon*)

MALEFICENT. Ow! Come on! Fine! (*breathes fire on everything*)

KING. Ah! Fire. Prince! You're on fire.

PRINCE. You bet I am. Yes! Behold the power of my true love. (*He strikes with some clever use of fire, a sword, a rock or something else.*)

MALEFICENT. Noooooooooo! Dang it. Diaval! Into a getaway.

DIAVAL. Caw! (*transforms into a getaway and they run off together*)

MALEFICENT. This isn't over! This isn't over!!!!

PRINCE. (*to Princess Aurora*) And now, my love. Our time has come. (*kisses her*)

AURORA. Oh my Prince! I knew my fairy godmother would bring you to me, and so she has. Do you think I shall ever see her again?

KING. Not likely.

PRINCE. Only if she's some kind of foolish fooly fool.